



INTERNATIONAL FOUNDATION FOR DIGITAL CHILD

Gender Equality Policy (GEP)

2023



IFDC 

Definition

1. Workplace Harassment: Workplace harassment refers to unwelcome or offensive behavior, actions, or comments directed towards an individual or a group of individuals in a work environment. Harassment can take various forms, including verbal, physical, or written actions, and it often creates a hostile, intimidating, or offensive atmosphere. Workplace harassment can be based on various factors, including but not limited to gender, race, age, sexual orientation, or religion.

2. Gender Inequality: Gender inequality refers to the unequal treatment, opportunities, or outcomes experienced by individuals based on their gender. It encompasses a wide range of disparities that may exist between men and women or between individuals of different gender identities. These disparities can include differences in pay, access to education, employment opportunities, representation in leadership roles, and societal expectations.

3. Gender Discrimination: Gender discrimination involves treating individuals unfairly or differently based on their gender or gender-related characteristics. This discrimination can manifest in various forms, such as hiring, promotion, compensation, or access to resources, and it typically results in disadvantageous or unequal treatment based solely on gender.

4. Gender-Based Maltreatment: Gender-based maltreatment is a broad term that encompasses any harmful or unjust treatment directed at an individual due to their gender. This can include various forms of harassment, discrimination, or abuse, as well as societal norms and practices that perpetuate unequal treatment based on gender.

5. Gender-Based Violence (GBV): Gender-based violence (GBV) is a term used to describe any form of violence or harm that is directed at individuals or groups specifically because of their gender. GBV disproportionately affects women and individuals with diverse gender identities and expressions, and it is a grave violation of human rights. GBV can take various forms and occurs in different contexts, including the home, workplace, community, and society at large. Here are some common forms of gender-based violence:

- **Physical Violence:** This includes acts such as physical assault, hitting, slapping, beating, or any form of bodily harm inflicted on an individual based on their gender.
- **Sexual Violence:** Sexual violence encompasses a wide range of non-consensual sexual acts, including rape, sexual assault, sexual harassment, and forced prostitution. It also includes practices like female genital mutilation (FGM) and child marriage.
- **Psychological or Emotional Abuse:** This form of GBV involves behavior intended to control, manipulate, or degrade an individual emotionally or psychologically. It may include threats, humiliation, intimidation, or constant criticism.
- **Economic Abuse:** Economic abuse involves controlling an individual's financial resources or restricting their access to economic opportunities, such as employment or education, based on their **gender**.
- **Cyber Harassment:** In the digital age, GBV can also occur online. Cyber harassment includes the use of technology and the internet to engage in harassment, threats, stalking, or the dissemination of explicit or private content without consent.

- **Honor Killings:** In some cultures, individuals, particularly women, may be subjected to violence, including murder, in the name of protecting family honor or reputation.
- **Forced Marriage:** Individuals, especially girls and women, may be forced into marriage against their will, often for cultural or economic reasons, resulting in ongoing physical and emotional abuse.
- **Sex Trafficking:** GBV includes sex trafficking, where individuals are coerced, deceived, or forced into the commercial sex industry through violence or threats.

GBV is a pervasive and deeply rooted issue, and it often occurs within a broader context of gender inequality and discrimination. Efforts to combat GBV include raising awareness, providing support services for survivors, implementing legal frameworks to protect individuals, and challenging harmful gender norms and stereotypes that contribute to its perpetuation. Many organizations and governments work to address GBV through policies, programs, and initiatives aimed at prevention, support, and legal enforcement.

Article I - Objective

The objective of the Gender Equality Policy (GEP) at the International Foundation for Digital Child (IFDC) is to ensure fair and equitable treatment for all staff members, partners, and affiliates, irrespective of their gender, and to uphold best practices that respect diversity and promote inclusion.

Article II - Principles

IFDC is unwavering in its dedication to upholding the rights of children, young people, women, and the LGBTQ+ community. We firmly believe that promoting gender equity is not only a moral imperative but also a catalyst for enhancing our operational and organizational effectiveness, ultimately fostering sustainable social progress. Our core principles, which underscore our commitment, are articulated as follows:

a) Commitment to Gender Equity: Our commitment to gender equity permeates every facet of our work, ensuring that our organizational efforts are optimized for maximum effectiveness while actively contributing to the advancement of society.

b) Equal Opportunities: We are dedicated to acknowledging and celebrating the diverse contributions of all genders equally. We steadfastly provide equal opportunities for influence at all organizational levels and ensure equitable access to services, benefits, information, and facilities for everyone.

c) Inclusive Culture: At IFDC, we are resolute in nurturing a culture of respect, inclusion, and equitable treatment for all individuals within our sphere, including employees, employers, and affiliates. To this end, we embrace the following guiding principles:

Article III - Merit-Based Recruitment

IFDC ensures equal opportunities for all job applicants throughout the recruitment process. Evaluation is based solely on skills, capabilities, and the ability to excel in specific job roles, without consideration of gender, sexual orientation, ethnicity, cultural background, or any other social, economic, religious, or political factors.

Article IV - Equal Pay and Benefits

IFDC ensures that all staff members and consultants receive fair compensation based on their skills and experience, regardless of gender identity. We treat both full-time and part-time employees equitably in terms of pay.

Article V - Inclusive Decision Making

a) Staff Input: IFDC encourages staff members to voice their concerns regarding ongoing or upcoming projects and daily activities as needed.

b) Equal Decision Making: The IFDC management ensures equal decision-making opportunities for all employees collaborating on specific projects.

c) Right to Raise Concerns: All staff members have the right to voice their concern regarding any activities happening at IFDC if that is in violation of the principles of GEP.

Article VI - Zero Tolerance for Harassment

IFDC maintains a zero-tolerance policy for harassment in any form. All parties associated with IFDC are expected to exhibit professional behavior at all times, refraining from engaging in any form of unacceptable conduct, including sexual comments, requests for sexual favors, sexual assault, and similar behaviors.

Article VII - Flexible Working Environment

IFDC does not discriminate based on caring responsibilities and promotes a flexible working environment with adequate leave policies. We support employees in achieving a healthy work-life balance and provide training to the management to facilitate flexible working arrangements.

Article VIII - Reporting Mechanism

IFDC President, Director/CEO, and Secretary will serve as the GEP committee. This committee will include at least five members, including members from the board of directors.

a) Reporting Complaints: Any staff can submit written complaints. GEP@IDFCHILD.ORG

b) Preliminary Inquiry: All violations of GEP should be preliminarily inquired by the head of HR and Director CEO and approved by the GEP committee.

c) Legal Actions: The GEP committee will propose appropriate legal actions as per local laws and may terminate contracts for proven involvement in harassment and gender-based discrimination.

d) Expedited Decisions: Based on the urgency and the significance of the violation, the Director/CEO can make fast decisions in consultation with the chair of the GEP committee or the President of IFDC.

Article IX - Implementation

a) Responsibility: The GEP committee will be responsible for implementing this policy.

b) Training: IFDC will provide annual gender equality training for all staff.

c) Annual Review: The GEP committee will meet at least twice a year to review compliance with the policy.

d) Policy Evaluation: The GEP will be evaluated every year.

Article X - Endorsement

All members of the Board of Directors, staff members, and affiliates will sign the Gender Equality Policy to demonstrate their commitment to its principles.

Declaration

I have read the Gender Equality Policy carefully and agree to abide by the principles stated in the policy.

Name:

Designation:

Date: